

Policy Document 2: Specialty Medication & Therapeutics

Clinical Policy: Biologic Therapy for Moderate-to-Severe Plaque Psoriasis (HCPCS J3590 / J1745)

Effective Date: April 15, 2026

Review Cycle: Bi-Annual

I. Policy Statement

Specialty formulary exception and prior authorization are required for the initiation or continuation of biologic therapy (including but not limited to TNF-inhibitors and IL-17/23 inhibitors) for the treatment of plaque psoriasis in an outpatient or infusion center setting.

II. Initial Authorization Criteria (Approval Duration: 6 Months)

Initial authorization will be granted only if the patient meets all of the following clinical prerequisites:

Age and Diagnosis: Patient is 18 years of age or older with a confirmed diagnosis of chronic, stable moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis.

Body Surface Area (BSA) Threshold: Documented plaque involvement covers greater than or equal to 10% of total body surface area, OR involves crucial functional areas (e.g., face, palms, soles of feet, or genitalia).

Step Therapy Failure: Documented clinical failure, intolerance, or absolute contraindication to a consecutive 90-day trial of at least one systemic non-biologic agent (e.g., Methotrexate, Cyclosporine) AND a 4-week trial of high-potency topical corticosteroids.

Infection Screening: Negative Tuberculosis (TB) IGRA blood test or QuantiferON-TB gold skin test results obtained within 30 days prior to the request date.

III. Renewal and Continuity of Care Criteria (Approval Duration: 12 Months)

For subsequent re-authorization, clinical notes must objectively demonstrate a positive therapeutic response, defined as a minimum 50% reduction in baseline BSA involvement or a significant improvement in the Psoriasis Area and Severity Index (PASI) score since biological therapy initiation.